world will see a parallel in Sunni Islamist discourse, in the argument over participation in democratic governments between groups like the Muslim Brotherhood and more rigid *salafis*.)

So the attacks on the army in Yitzhar were not unprecedented. Settlers broke into the regional army command near Beit El in 2012 to protest demolitions in the Migron outpost and elsewhere. A similar riot in 2011 targeted an army base in the Jordan Valley. “There’s a long history of this kind of behavior,” said Yehuda Shaul, a member of Breaking the Silence, a group of former Israeli soldiers who document the army’s activities in the West Bank. “The discrimination in law enforcement is embedded in the system. The fact is that police are not given orders to crack down on settler violence.”

The residents of Yitzhar, like their neighbors in other settlements, often accuse the army of doing the exact opposite—turning a blind eye to acts of Palestinian violence against them. Four times in the winter of 2014, they said, buses carrying girls back from school were attacked with Molotov cocktails, and they complained that the army did nothing to stop it. “Sometimes we feel that the army is more like the United Nations, in between [us], to separate [us], and there are complaints about it,” Tubi said. (Lerner dismissed the criticism, calling it “outright wrong.”)

But the bulk of the violence goes in the other direction, as the UN statistics indicate. The Israeli army and police are often ill-prepared, or simply unwilling, to respond. In January of 2014, for example, masked settlers from Yitzhar raided a water reservoir being built in the nearly Palestinian village of Urif. They threw stones at schools and family homes. A video released by the human rights group B’Tselem showed Israeli soldiers standing nearby, watching idly. They made no effort to stop the violence or arrest the perpetrators. The army is required (under the Geneva Conventions) to protect Palestinians living under its control, but it rarely does. The Shin Bet has a “Jewish division”, meant to crack down on extremists, but it was long seen as a backwater, the sort of “promotion” that might derail a career.

Yitzhar and the other ideological communities near Nablus are often described as a blight on the settler movement—not least by the settler leaders themselves. Dani Dayan, who was then a senior member of the Yesha Council, an umbrella organisation of settler groups, said he would support jailing violent settlers in Yitzhar under “administrative detention”.